

CLASSES

Adventurers are a cut above the average person. They have power, they have skill, and they have Lady Luck smiling upon them, favoring them with the sort of good fortune that lets them succeed where others fail, sometimes despite overwhelming odds. This ever-growing capability is represented by a character's class, one of the most important choices a player selects for a character.

CLASSES

BARBARIAN

The barbarian is a brutal berserker from beyond the edge of civilized lands.

BARD

The bard uses skill and spell alike to bolster his allies, confound his enemies, and build upon his fame.

CLERIC

A devout follower of a deity, the cleric can heal wounds, raise the dead, and call down the wrath of the gods.

DRUID

The druid is a worshiper of all things natural—a spellcaster, a friend to animals, and a skilled shapechanger.

FIGHTER

Brave and stalwart, the fighter is a master of all manner of arms and armor.

MONK

A student of martial arts, the monk trains his body to be his greatest weapon and defense.

PALADIN

The paladin is the knight in shining armor, a devoted follower of law and good.

RANGER

A tracker and hunter, the ranger is a creature of the wild and of tracking down his favored foes.

ROGUE

The rogue is a thief and a scout, an opportunist capable of delivering brutal strikes against unwary foes.

SORCERER

The spellcasting sorcerer is born with an innate knack for magic and has strange, eldritch powers.

WIZARD

The wizard masters magic through constant study that gives him incredible magical power.

CHARACTER ADVANCEMENT

As player characters overcome challenges, they gain experience points. As these points accumulate, PCs advance in level and power. The rate of this advancement depends on the type of game that your group wants to play. Some prefer a fast-paced game, where characters gain levels every few sessions, while others prefer a game where advancement occurs less frequently. In the end, it is up to your group to decide what rate fits you best. Characters advance in level according to Table: Character Advancement and Level-Dependent Bonuses.

ADVANCING YOUR CHARACTER

A character advances in level as soon as he earns enough experience points to do so—typically, this occurs at the end of a game session, when your GM hands out that session's experience point awards.

The process of advancing a character works in much the same way as generating a character, except that your ability scores, race, and previous choices concerning class, skills, and feats cannot be changed. Adding a level generally gives you new abilities, additional skill points to spend, more hit points, and possibly an ability score increase or additional feat (see Table: Character Advancement and Level-Dependent Bonuses). Over time, as your character rises to higher levels, he becomes a truly powerful force in the game world, capable of ruling nations or bringing them to their knees.

When adding new levels of an existing class or adding levels of a new class (see Multiclassing, below), make sure to take the following steps in order. First, select your new class level. You must be able to qualify for this level before any of the following adjustments are made. Second, apply any ability score increases due to gaining a level. Third, integrate all of the level's class abilities and then roll for additional hit points. Finally, add new skills and feats. For more information on when you gain new feats and ability score increases, see Table: Character Advancement and Level-Dependent Bonuses.

Table: Character Advancement and Level-Dependent Bonuses

CHARACTER LEVEL	EXPERIENCE POINT TOTAL	FEATS	ABILITY SCORE
Slow	Medium	Fast	
1st	-	-	-
2nd	3,000	2,000	1,300
3rd	7,500	5,000	3,300
4th	14,000	9,000	6,000
5th	23,000	15,000	10,000
6th	35,000	23,000	15,000
7th	53,000	35,000	23,000
8th	77,000	51,000	34,000
9th	115,000	75,000	50,000
10th	160,000	105,000	71,000
11th	235,000	155,000	105,000
12th	330,000	220,000	145,000
13th	475,000	315,000	210,000
14th	665,000	445,000	295,000
15th	955,000	635,000	425,000
16th	1,350,000	890,000	600,000
17th	1,900,000	1,300,000	850,000
18th	2,700,000	1,800,000	1,200,000
19th	3,850,000	2,550,000	1,700,000
20th	5,350,000	3,600,000	2,400,000

MULTICLASSING

Instead of gaining the abilities granted by the next level in your character's current class, he can instead gain the 1st-level abilities of a new class, adding all of those abilities to his existing ones. This is known as "multiclassing."

For example, let's say a 5th-level fighter decides to dabble in the arcane arts, and adds one level of wizard when he advances to 6th level. Such a character would have the powers and abilities of both a 5th-level fighter and a 1st-level wizard, but would still be considered a 6th-level character. (His class levels would be 5th and 1st, but his total character level is 6th.) He keeps all of his bonus feats gained from 5 levels of fighter, but can now also cast 1st-level spells and picks an arcane school. He adds all of the hit points, base attack bonuses, and saving throw bonuses from a 1st-level wizard on top of those gained from being a 5th-level fighter.

Note that there are a number of effects and prerequisites that rely on a character's level or Hit Dice. Such effects are always based on the total number of levels or Hit Dice a character possesses, not just those from one class. The exception to this is class abilities, most of which are based on the total number of class levels that a character possesses of that particular class.

FAVORED CLASS

Each character begins play with a single favored class of his choosing—typically, this is the same class as the one he chooses at 1st level. Whenever a character gains a level in his favored class, he receives either +1 hit point or +1 skill rank. The choice of favored class cannot be changed once the character is created, and the choice of gaining a hit point or a skill rank each time a character gains a level (including his first level) cannot be changed once made for a particular level. Prestige classes (see Prestige Classes) can never be a favored class.

PRESTIGE CLASSES

Prestige classes allow characters to become truly exceptional, gaining powers beyond the ken of their peers. Unlike the core classes, characters must meet specific requirements before they can take their first level of a prestige class. If a character does not meet the requirements for a prestige class before gaining any benefits of that level, that character cannot take that prestige class. Characters that take levels in prestige classes do not gain any favored class bonuses for those levels.

ARCANE ARCHER

An arcane spellcaster who draws upon ancient elven traditions to infuse his arrows with potent magical power.

ARCANE TRICKSTER

A troublemaker and a scoundrel who uses arcane magic to enhance her thievery and trickery.

ASSASSIN

A remorseless murderer who kills for money and the sheer thrill of death-dealing.

DRAGON DISCIPLE

An arcane spellcaster who has embraced his latent draconic heritage and, over the course of training and devotion, undergoes a partial transformation into a dragon.

DUELIST

A swashbuckling swordfighter who relies upon grace, poise, and acrobatics to win the day.

ELDRITCH KNIGHT

An arcane spellcaster who augments his magical skills with combat to create a deadly combination of weapons and magic.

LOREMASTER

A spellcaster who devotes his life to research and rumination upon the mysteries of the world.

MYSTIC THEURGE

Equally devoted to divine and arcane magic, the mystic theurge combines both magical traditions into one incredibly diverse class.

PATHFINDER CHRONICLER

An explorer at heart, the Pathfinder chronicler travels to distant, exotic lands to expand her knowledge of the world.

SHADOWDANCER

A mysterious adventurer who walks the boundaries between the real world and the realm of shadows, and who can command shadows to do her bidding.

DEFINITIONS OF TERMS

Here are definitions of some terms used in this section.

Core Class

One of the standard eleven classes found in Classes.

Caster Level

Generally equal to the number of class levels (see below) in a spellcasting class. Some prestige classes add caster levels to an existing class.

Character Level

The total level of the character, which is the sum of all class levels held by that character.

Class Level

The level of a character in a particular class. For a character with levels in only one class, class level and character level are the same.